UNITY OF PRODUCTION

2024-2029

1. Background To the Production unit.

Having noted that Vision Jeunesse Nouvelle, as a non-governmental organization, could not receive sponsorships from other organizations and faced irregularities in donations, the administration of the said organization came up with the idea of creating a production unit whose mission would be to centralize all activities to facilitate the collection of funds and the creation of income-generating activities with a view to ensuring the organization's longevity.

As a result of the irregularity of donations, Vision Jeunesse Nouvelle established a new department called the Unity of Production, effective November 2024.

Objectives

Efficiency in resource utilization

Ensures that all inputs (labor, capital, raw materials, and technology) are used optimally to minimize waste and maximize output.

Helps in coordinating resources to achieve economies of scale.

Streamlined production process

Facilitates the integration of various production stages to create a seamless flow of activities.

Reduces bottlenecks and delays, improving overall productivity.

Cost reduction

Centralizing and organizing production activities can lower production costs by leveraging shared resources and economies of scale.

Encourages process innovations that reduce operational expenses.

Product quality assurance

Provides a structured environment for maintaining consistent quality across products and services.

Encourages adherence to standards and quality benchmarks.

Flexibility and scalability

Makes it easier to adapt to changes in demand or introduce new products.

Allows for scaling up production without disrupting ongoing processes.

Coordination and collaboration

Enhances communication and collaboration among departments, teams, or stakeholders involved in the production process.

Encourages synergy among workers, machinery, and management systems.

Profit maximization

Aligns production strategies with the organization’s goals to achieve higher profitability.

Balances costs, productivity, and quality to maximize returns.

Sustainability

Encourages environmentally sustainable practices by optimizing resource use and reducing waste.

Incorporates energy-efficient technologies and renewable resources where possible.

Customer Satisfaction

Focuses on delivering products that meet customer needs in terms of quality, quantity, and timely delivery.

Supports building a reputation for reliability and excellence in the market.

Innovation and Development

Encourages continuous improvement in production techniques, tools, and processes.

Supports research and development (R&D) to remain competitive in the market.

In summary, the primary objective of establishing the Unity of Production is to develop an organized, efficient, and effective system that supports the strategic goals of Vision Jeunesse Nouvelle while adapting to both external and internal challenges.

Problematic/ Purpose of the production unit

The production unit is essential because it plays a central role in organizing and carrying out economic activities aimed at producing goods and services. Here are the main reasons why the production unit is important:

1. Work organization

Allows the different stages of production to be structured and coordinated.

Encourages the specialization of tasks to improve productivity.

2. Resource optimization

Ensures efficient use of available resources (labor, capital, raw materials, machinery).

Reduces waste and maximizes profitability.

3. Mass Production

Facilitates the production of goods or services in large quantities to meet demand.

Allows you to benefit from economies of scale, thereby reducing the unit cost of production.

4. Meeting consumer needs

Produces goods or services adapted to consumer expectations in terms of quality, quantity and lead time.

Contributes to customer satisfaction and loyalty.

5. Value Creation

Transforms inputs (raw resources) into outputs (finished products or services), thereby adding value to the economy.

Helps generate profits for companies and jobs for society.

6. Contribution to the economy

Production units are at the heart of the economic system, generating income, jobs and taxes for governments.

Promote the industrial and economic development of a country.

7. Support for Innovation

Encourages the introduction of new technologies and methods to improve products, reduce costs and remain competitive on the market.

Encourages research and development (R&D).

8. Stability and Growth

A well-organized production unit contributes to the financial and operational stability of the company.

Plays a key role in the growth and expansion of business activities.

9. Compliance with Standards and Quality

Enables controls to be put in place to guarantee high quality standards.

Ensures compliance with environmental and social regulations and standards.

10. Cost reduction

A well-designed, efficient structure reduces production costs, enabling products to be offered at competitive prices.

4. Production unit activity

A. Infrastructure management

- Room hire
- Studio
- Garden
- Grounds
- Office space

B. Rental services

- Ballet
- Sound system
- Orchestra
- Acrobatics
- Canteen
- Bar and restaurant
- Transport
- Stationery
- Hardware store
- Shop selling young people's products (art objects, etc.)
- Hairdressing salon
- Welding workshop
- Sewing shop
- Food shop
- Graphic design

C. AGRICULTURE AND LIVESTOCK

1. Mushroom Growing

- **Description**: Mushroom cultivation involves growing fungi in controlled environments. It is a specialized agricultural activity that requires proper management of temperature, humidity, and light.
- **Process**:
  - **Substrate Preparation**: Materials like straw, sawdust, or compost are sterilized to create a growing medium.
  - **Inoculation**: Spores or spawn (mushroom seeds) are introduced into the substrate.
  - **Growth**: Mushrooms are grown in dark, humid, and well-ventilated spaces.
  - **Harvesting**: Harvested within weeks, depending on the mushroom variety.
- **Benefits**: High-value crop, space-efficient, and environmentally sustainable.

2. Vegetable Garden

- **Description**: A vegetable garden involves growing various vegetables for personal use, sale, or community needs. It can range from small-scale backyard plots to larger commercial operations.
- **Process**:
  - **Soil Preparation**: Soil is tilled and enriched with organic matter.
  - **Planting**: Seeds or seedlings of vegetables like tomatoes, carrots, and spinach are planted.
  - **Maintenance**: Includes watering, weeding, fertilizing, and pest control.
  - **Harvesting**: Vegetables are harvested at peak ripeness for maximum flavor and nutrition.
- **Benefits**: Provides fresh produce, promotes self-sufficiency, and supports local ecosystems.

3. Banana Plantation

- **Description**: Banana cultivation is the process of growing banana plants, typically in tropical and subtropical climates. It is a popular cash crop due to high demand.
- **Process**:

        - **Land Preparation**: Well-drained soil and sunny conditions are essential.
        - **Planting**: Banana suckers or tissue-cultured plants are planted at regular intervals.
        - **Maintenance**: Regular watering, fertilizing, and pest control are necessary.
        - **Harvesting**: Bananas are harvested when green and ripen during transportation.
    - **Benefits**: High-yield crop with consistent market demand; provides shade and prevents soil erosion.

4. Raising Chickens or Rabbits
    - **Description**: The practice of raising chickens or rabbits for meat, eggs, or as pets. It is a flexible agricultural activity suitable for small or large-scale farming.
    - **Chickens**:
        - **Setup**: Requires a coop, feeding stations, and nesting boxes for egg-laying.
        - **Care**: Includes feeding with grains or pellets, regular cleaning, and protection from predators.
        - **Products**: Eggs, meat, and manure (as fertilizer).
    - **Rabbits**:
        - **Setup**: Needs cages or hutches, a feeding system, and ventilation.
        - **Care**: Diet includes hay, vegetables, and pellets.
        - **Products**: Meat, fur, and manure.
    - **Benefits**: Quick reproduction cycles and relatively low maintenance.

5. Pig Farming
    - **Description**: Pig farming involves raising pigs for meat (pork) and by-products like fat and leather. It is a profitable livestock activity with significant market demand.
    - **Process**:
        - **Setup**: Requires pens with proper drainage and ventilation.
        - **Feeding**: Pigs are fed a balanced diet of grains, vegetables, and protein supplements.

    - **Breeding**: Managed for optimal production of piglets.
    - **Care**: Regular health check-ups and vaccinations are essential.
    - **Slaughter and Processing**: Pigs are sold for meat or processed into other products.
- **Benefits**: High growth rate, efficient feed-to-meat conversion, and multiple revenue streams.

5. Production unit organisation chart

1. Production Unit Manager

- **Role**: The production unit manager oversees the overall operations of the production unit and ensures its goals and objectives are met.
- **Responsibilities**:
    - ✓ Developing and implementing production plans and schedules.
    - ✓ Managing resources (human, financial, and material) efficiently.
    - ✓ Ensuring compliance with policies, safety standards, and regulations.
    - ✓ Coordinating between different departments to maintain smooth operations.
    - ✓ Monitoring performance metrics and making strategic decisions.
- **Contribution**: Provides leadership and vision to align all activities with organizational goals, ensuring productivity and profitability.

2. Internal Auditor

- **Role**: The internal auditor evaluates the financial and operational integrity of the production unit.
- **Responsibilities**:
    - ✓ Conducting audits to ensure proper use of resources and adherence to policies.
    - ✓ Identifying risks and recommending mitigation strategies.
    - ✓ Reviewing financial records, inventory, and production processes for accuracy.
    - ✓ Assessing the effectiveness of internal controls and suggesting improvements.

- **Contribution**: Ensures transparency, accountability, and efficient resource management, reducing the risk of fraud or inefficiency.

3. Heads of Departments

- **Role**: Department heads manage specific areas of the production unit, such as finance, operations, logistics, or quality control.
- **Responsibilities**:
  - ✓ Setting goals for their department aligned with overall production objectives.
  - ✓ Managing teams, allocating tasks, and ensuring timely completion of activities.
  - ✓ Monitoring departmental performance and addressing any issues or bottlenecks.
  - ✓ Reporting progress and challenges to the production unit manager.
- **Contribution**: Ensures specialized focus on key operational areas, contributing to the overall success of the production unit.

4. Supervisors

- **Role**: Supervisors oversee the day-to-day activities of workers, ensuring tasks are performed efficiently and to required standards.
- **Responsibilities**:
  - ✓ Monitoring and guiding employees in their tasks.
  - ✓ Enforcing safety measures and operational procedures.
  - ✓ Reporting production progress and any challenges to department heads or the manager.
  - ✓ Training and motivating workers to improve productivity.
- **Contribution**: Acts as a link between workers and management, ensuring smooth execution of tasks and maintaining quality and efficiency.

5. Marketing and Innovation

- **Role**: This team or individual focuses on promoting the unit's products and driving innovation to maintain competitiveness in the market.
- **Responsibilities**:
  - ✓ Developing marketing strategies to reach target markets effectively.

- ✓ Conducting market research to understand consumer needs and trends.
- ✓ Innovating products, processes, or services to enhance value and profitability.
- ✓ Managing branding, advertising, and customer relations.

- **Contribution**: Expands market reach, enhances product appeal, and ensures the unit adapts to changing market dynamics.

6. Agronomist/Veterinarian

- **Role**: Specialized professionals responsible for ensuring the health of crops or animals, depending on the nature of the production unit.
- **Agronomist**:
    - ✓ Advises on soil health, crop selection, and farming techniques.
    - ✓ Monitors pest and disease control strategies.
    - ✓ Provides guidance on irrigation, fertilization, and sustainable practices.
- **Veterinarian**:
    - ✓ Ensures the health and welfare of livestock.
    - ✓ Conducts regular health check-ups, vaccinations, and treatments.
    - ✓ Provides advice on animal nutrition, housing, and breeding.
- **Contribution**: Enhances productivity by ensuring optimal health and sustainability of the unit's agricultural or livestock systems.

- Support staff (drivers, workers, waiters)

6. Monitoring

Both monitoring and auditing are vital in our unity of production. Monitoring ensures real-time control and immediate problem-solving, while auditing provides a comprehensive review to drive long-term improvements and accountability. Together, they form a robust system to maintain operational excellence and sustainability.

All these continuous processes of observing and tracking activities, processes, and performance ensure that goals are met and issues are addressed promptly.

- **Objectives**:

1. Ensure day-to-day operations align with production plans.
2. Identify inefficiencies, bottlenecks, or deviations from standards.
3. Provide real-time feedback to management and workers.
4. Track resource utilization to prevent waste or misuse.

Key Areas to Monitor:

- ✓ **Production Processes**: Monitoring workflow, machine performance, and output levels.
- ✓ **Resource Utilization**: Ensuring optimal use of raw materials, labor, and energy.
- ✓ **Quality Control**: Regular checks to maintain product standards.
- ✓ **Employee Performance**: Tracking attendance, task completion, and adherence to safety protocols.
- ✓ **Environmental Impact**: Monitoring emissions, waste management, and sustainability practices.

Tools and Techniques:

- ✓ Performance dashboards and reports.
- ✓ Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for production, quality, and efficiency.
- ✓ Supervisory oversight and real-time tracking systems.

Auditing

- **Definition**: A systematic, independent evaluation of operations, finances, and compliance to ensure the unity of production adheres to its objectives, policies, and regulations.
- **Types of Audits**:
  1. **Financial Audit**: Examines financial records to ensure accuracy and transparency.
  2. **Operational Audit**: Evaluates processes to improve efficiency and effectiveness.
  3. **Compliance Audit**: Ensures adherence to legal, safety, and environmental regulations.
  4. **Quality Audit**: Verifies that products and processes meet established quality standards.
- **Objectives**:
  1. Detect errors, fraud, or inefficiencies.

2. Provide recommendations for improvement.
3. Ensure compliance with internal policies and external regulations.
4. Build trust among stakeholders (management, investors, regulators).

Audit Process:

5. **Planning**: Define scope, objectives, and criteria for the audit.
6. **Data Collection**: Gather information through interviews, observations, and document reviews.
7. **Analysis**: Compare findings against benchmarks, policies, and regulations.
8. **Reporting**: Provide a detailed report with findings, risks, and recommendations.
9. **Follow-Up**: Monitor the implementation of corrective actions.

Benefits of Monitoring and Auditing:

- ✓ **Improved Efficiency**: Identifies inefficiencies and provides actionable insights to streamline operations.
- ✓ **Cost Control**: Tracks resource usage to minimize waste and unnecessary expenses.
- ✓ **Risk Mitigation**: Detects potential risks (financial, operational, or regulatory) early on.
- ✓ **Quality Assurance**: Ensures products or services meet customer expectations and industry standards.
- ✓ **Accountability**: Holds employees and departments responsible for their roles.
- ✓ **Sustainability**: Monitors environmental impacts and promotes sustainable practices.

7. Inventory

This refers to the stock of materials, components, products, and resources necessary for production and operation. Effective inventory management ensures smooth production processes, reduces waste, and helps maintain financial stability.

1. **Raw Materials**:
   - ✓ Materials required for production (e.g., seeds, fertilizers, feed for livestock, or construction materials for infrastructure).
   - ✓ Example: For a banana plantation, raw materials might include fertilizers, pesticides, and irrigation equipment.
2. **Work-in-Progress (WIP)**:
   - Partially completed products that are still in the production process.
   - Example: Bananas at various growth stages or unprocessed mushrooms in cultivation.
3. **Finished Goods**:
   - Completed products ready for sale or distribution.
   - Example: Packaged mushrooms, harvested bananas, or processed meat from pigs.
4. **Maintenance, Repair, and Operations (MRO) Supplies**:
   - Items used for maintaining equipment and operations but not directly part of the final product.
   - Example: Tools, machinery spare parts, and cleaning supplies.
5. **Packaging Materials**:
   - Materials used for storing and transporting finished products.
   - Example: Boxes, crates, or plastic wraps for bananas or vegetable products.

Objectives of Inventory Management

1. **Ensure Continuous Production**:
   - Avoid production halts by maintaining sufficient raw materials and components.
2. **Optimize Costs**:
   - Balance between holding costs (storage) and ordering costs (procurement).
3. **Meet Market Demand**:
   - Keep adequate finished goods to meet customer orders and market demand.

4. **Minimize Waste**:
    - Prevent spoilage, obsolescence, or overstocking of perishable goods.
5. **Increase Efficiency**:
    - Streamline production schedules by having the right materials at the right time.

Inventory Management Techniques

1. **Economic Order Quantity (EOQ)**:
    - Determines the optimal order quantity to minimize costs.
2. **Just-in-Time (JIT)**:
    - Keeps inventory levels low by ordering materials only when needed.
3. **First-In, First-Out (FIFO)**:
    - Ensures older inventory is used or sold first to prevent spoilage or obsolescence.
4. **Stock Reordering Points**:
    - Sets minimum stock levels to trigger automatic reordering.
5. **ABC Analysis**:
    - ➢ Categorizes inventory into three groups:
    - **A**: High-value, low-quantity items.
    - **B**: Moderate value and quantity.
    - **C**: Low-value, high-quantity items.

Key Practices for Effective Inventory in a Unity of Production

1. **Regular Stock Monitoring**:
    - Use manual counts or automated systems to track inventory levels.
2. **Storage Optimization**:
    - Ensure proper storage conditions (temperature, humidity, ventilation) to prevent spoilage or damage.
    - Example: Cold storage for perishable items like vegetables or mushrooms.
3. **Inventory Records**:

- Maintain accurate records to track stock movements and prevent theft or mismanagement.

4. **Forecasting**:
   - Use historical data and market trends to predict demand and plan inventory levels accordingly.
5. **Integration with Production Planning**:
   - Align inventory with production schedules to avoid overstocking or understocking.
6. **Waste Management**:
   - Implement processes for disposing of expired or damaged goods responsibly.

Challenges in Inventory Management

1. **Perishable Goods**:
   - Items like vegetables, mushrooms, or meat have short shelf lives and require careful planning.
2. **Unpredictable Demand**:
   - Market fluctuations can lead to overstocking or shortages.
3. **Storage Costs**:
   - Maintaining large inventories can increase costs for storage, insurance, and handling.
4. **Supply Chain Disruptions**:
   - Delays in raw material deliveries can impact production schedules.

Importance of Inventory in a Unity of Production

1. **Ensures Smooth Operations**:
   - Reliable inventory avoids production downtime.
2. **Supports Financial Health**:
   - Efficient inventory management minimizes waste and lowers costs.
3. **Enhances Customer Satisfaction**:
   - Ensures timely delivery of finished goods to meet customer needs.
4. **Facilitates Sustainability**:

- Reduces overstocking, waste, and environmental impact through proper planning.

8. Staff reinforcement
9. Report